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Al Maktoum airport expansion on track

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Work on the Al Maktoum International Airport expansion continues according to the approved timeline, with Phase 1 scheduled to begin operations in 2032.

The first phase of the development is moving ahead across key work streams, including enabling works, runway infrastructure and the initial structural foundations for passenger terminals and gates. Contracts worth Dh13 billion are currently under execution, while strategic contracts exceeding Dh55 billion are set to be awarded in the next phase.

World's largest

The airport is being developed to become the world's largest aviation hub, with annual capacity of more than 260 million passengers and 12 million tonnes of air cargo once its final phase is completed.

Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE, and Chairman of The Executive Council of Dubai, said: "A key enabler of the objectives of the Dubai Economic Agenda, D33, the Al Maktoum International Airport project will expand the aviation sector's capacity and enhance the efficiency of the emirate's transport and logistics ecosystem."

UAE URGES US-IRAN MOU COMPLIANCE AS TRUMP TOUTS HORMUZ 'OIL FLOW'

Iran's Hormuz fee plan adds uncertainty ahead of deal signing

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE has stressed the importance of dialogue, diplomacy and adherence to international law following the announcement of a memorandum of understanding (MoU) between the US and Iran.

The Ministry of Foreign Affairs underscored the importance of full compliance with the terms of the agreement, saying this would help ensure an immediate and comprehensive halt to hostile actions in the region. The ministry also emphasised respect for state sovereignty, good neighbourliness and strict compliance with international law.

It underlined the importance of protecting maritime routes and safeguarding freedom of international navigation, including uninterrupted traffic through the Strait of Hormuz, contributing to regional and global stability. It also commended US President Donald Trump's diplomatic efforts and the role of countries involved in reaching the understanding.

Welcoming the move

Meanwhile, Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, Qatar, Iraq, Turkey, Jordan and Egypt welcomed the MoU, expressing hope it would pave the way for lasting stability and broader diplomatic engagement.

Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif, whose country mediated the talks, told lawmakers:



UAE Presidential Court

■ President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan meets Egyptian President Abdel Fattah el-Sisi at Al Ittihadiya Palace in Cairo during his visit to Egypt yesterday.

"Today, the world has seen a historic step towards peace. After the darkness of war, the sun of peace has risen."

Trump said the agreement marked a historic step toward stabilising the Middle East and restoring global energy flows, claiming the US would lift its blockade of Iranian ports and reopen the Strait of Hormuz without tolls. "Ships of the world, start your engines. Let the oil flow!" Trump said on Truth Social.

He added that loaded oil tankers were "starting to move" out

of the strait, apparently near Oman. Oil prices eased and stocks rallied yesterday, as markets reacted positively to the announcement.

Mixed signals

However, shipping through Hormuz remained virtually at a standstill, tracking data showed. At 1400 GMT, Kpler detected only one commodities carrier crossing the strait during the day.

The framework paves the way for 60-day negotiations on Iran's nuclear programme and sanctions relief.

Trump arrived in France for the G7 summit, where the Iran deal is expected to dominate discussions, alongside expectations of a signing in Geneva on Friday.

Iran also indicated it would impose maritime service fees for vessels using Hormuz, rejecting the term "tolls".

While details remain unclear, Iran confirmed the deal covers cessation of hostilities across fronts, including Lebanon.

An Israeli drone strike in southern Lebanon yesterday killed one person, officials said.

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